Above Us Only Sky

by

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EXT. BEACH- NIGHT

LENNON sits on a towel just out of reach of the tide, her knees pulled up to her chest. Her hair is long and gets blown in the wind, spreading across her face. She wears a hoodie and leggings but no shoes. Headphones sit in her ears, connected to her phone which sits beside her.

A bag sits next to Lennon on the towel. A set of keys, a water bottle, her shoes, and a journal and pen lay on the towel scattered. Lining the beach are houses and palm trees.

Lennon's hair moves in the breeze again as she looks up at the sky. Her nose and cheeks are slightly pink. She pulls the headphones from her ears and moves forward on the towel.

She sticks her feet in the sand in front of her and moves them around. She smiles, closing her eyes. She looks at the waves in front of her, the tide reaching close to her toes.

A hermit crab scurries across the tide in front of Lennon. Her eyes track the crab, smiling when it burrows into the sand.

She reaches next to her and grabs her journal and a pen. Lennon opens it to a new blank page. She takes a deep breath and looks around before smiling. She begins to write.

INSERT JOURNAL:

It's peaceful tonight. The stars and waves seem to be friends, shining off each other. The sand is soft, but I've noticed more shells scattered throughout. My hermit crab friend is back. I think he'll change shells soon. Every time I'm out here I remember how happy I am. The stillness and simplicity allow me to be myself. To enjoy. I get to be an observer of something bigger than me. Greater than me.

RATTLING in the distance makes Lennon's hand stop writing. She looks up from her journal. HUNTER walks down the beach with a cardboard box in his hands. He wears a hoodie and sweatpants.

Lennon's eyes follow Hunter as he places the box down and sits beside it. Lennon's head tilts slightly, her eyes locked on Hunter. Her hair blows across her face and she reaches her hand to move it.

Lennon glances back down to her journal, tapping her pen against the page. She looks up again in Hunter's direction. There's a notebook in his hands and he is writing. Lennon

smiles, continuing to tap her pen. Her eyes stay on Hunter.

Hunter writes in his notebook. He scribbles something down before dropping his pen beside him. He takes a deep breath, head looking up at the stars. His hand rips out the page he was writing on and folds it in half.

From the box beside him, Hunter pulls out a plastic bag. He places the folded paper inside and seals the bag. He takes his sweatshirt off and folds it. He places his sweatshirt in the sand next to him and puts the plastic bag on top. He remains in sweatpants and a t-shirt.

Lennon continues to watch him, her journal now laying in her lap along with her pen.

Hunter reaches into the box, grabbing two handfuls of rocks. He places them in his sweatpants pockets and zips the pockets closed.

Lennon's eyebrows furrow as she continues to stare at Hunter. Hunter takes off his shoes and socks, placing them by his sweatshirt. He begins walking towards the ocean.

Lennon's eyes follow Hunter, slowly moving the journal and pen off her lap. Hunter's feet get wet in the tide. He stops walking.

Lennon's mouth parts, her eyes looking around. She sits up taller. She closes her mouth.

Hunter continues walking into the ocean until he is in shoulder deep water. The waves crash around him. His head goes under.

Lennon sucks in a breath, looking around. She quickly stands up, biting her thumb nail. She looks around again before taking a few steps forward. Hunter remains under water.

Lennon quickly runs into the ocean, the sand spraying behind her feet. She high knees into the ocean, letting out a squeal.

LENNON
(panic)
Hey! Hey!

Lennon frantically turns around in the ocean, waves crashing onto her thighs. She continues deeper into the ocean until she is fully swimming.

LENNON
(panic)
Hey! Where are you?

Bubbles come to the surface a few feet away from Lennon. She frantically swims over, splashing water everywhere. She drops under the water, arms swaying in front of her.

Her head bobs up. She takes a large breath before dipping her head back under. The water is still for a moment. Lennon emerges from underwater along with Hunter's upper body. She takes fast breaths. Hunter coughs and sucks in the air. His arms flail as Lennon struggles to hold onto his torso. She begins to swim back slowly.

HUNTER
(panic)
Stop! Let go of me!

Lennon continues dragging Hunter through the water.

HUNTER
Let go of me!

Hunter struggles, shifting his torso back and forth. Lennon's arms flex around him.

HUNTER
Stop! You're ruining it!

Lennon grunts as she stands up, still holding onto Hunter. Hunter pulls back, pushing Lennon off of him. He stands across from her.

Lennon is breathing heavily, her arms by her side. She stares blankly at Hunter. Hunter unzips his pockets, grabbing the rocks and throwing them into the ocean below him. He walks off. Lennon runs after him, grabbing his arm.

LENNON
Wait!

HUNTER
Leave me alone!

Hunter yanks his arm out of Lennon's hand. Turning around to face her.

LENNON
Will you come sit with me?

HUNTER
(confused)
What?

LENNON
Just come sit with me. We don't have to talk, we can just sit.

Hunter stares at Lennon. His eyes look toward Lennon's towel and bag. He takes a deep breath and begins walking in the direction of Lennon's things. She follows him.

Lennon and Hunter sit on her towel. Hunter stares into the ocean, knees pulled up to his chest. Lennon sits the same way, looking at Hunter. After a few moments she looks at the ocean.

The waves crash onto the shore. The moonlight casts a shimmer onto the sand. Lennon looks back at Hunter. A tear slowly drips down his cheek before he wipes it away.

LENNON
Why the ocean?

Hunter looks at her, eyebrows pulled together.

HUNTER
Huh?

LENNON
Why the pain of drowning? Why not take pills or something?

Hunter pauses and looks back at the ocean. He rests his chin on his forearms. Lennon watches him.

HUNTER
Didn't want my mom to find me.

Lennon nods. She lays down on her back, folding her hands together on her chest. Her hair blows onto her face. She doesn't brush it away.

LENNON
I like to journal here.

A pause.

HUNTER
I've seen you before.

Lennon turns her head to look at him.

HUNTER
You're always smiling when writing. Y'look peaceful.

LENNON
I find nature calming, connects us with reality.

Hunter lays down on his back next to Lennon. His hands folded together across his chest. He glances at Lennon before looking up at the stars. Lennon looks at the stars also.

LENNON
I'm Lennon.

HUNTER
Like the clothing material?

A soft GIGGLE interrupts the silence.

LENNON
Like John Lennon.

HUNTER
Hunter.

They continue looking at the stars. Lennon points up into the sky.

LENNON
Big dipper.

Hunter stays silent. His teeth CHATTER. A shooting star flies through the sky.

HUNTER
(sarcastically)
Make a wish.

Lennon smiles slightly, turning her head to look at Hunter.

LENNON
None of it matters ya know?

Hunter turns his head to look at her.

LENNON
What's causing your pain, it doesn't matter.

Lennon pauses. Hunter stays silent, making eye contact with her. Lennon looks away to the sky.

LENNON
You don't feel like you matter. None of us do. Nature is so vast and we're so insignificant.

HUNTER
Then why are we here?

LENNON
Who would enjoy the beauty of it if we weren't?

Hunter stares at her for a moment. A small smile paints his face. He looks back up at the stars.